# Grant Application: Budget and Justification

*Project: Riverbend Wetland and Bank Restoration, three years from 1 July 2027.*

## Applicant and project

| | |
|---|---|
| **Applicant** | Riverbend Conservation Trust |
| **Programme** | Living Waterways Fund, round 4 |
| **Reference** | GA-2027-0418 |
| **Amount requested** | $823,370 over three years |
| **Project area** | 14 km of the Millrace river, Eastfield district |

The budget below follows the funder's template, and every line is explained in the justification that follows it. Salary lines assume a 3 per cent annual increase from the second year.

## Budget by category

| Line | Description | Year 1 | Year 2 | Year 3 | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **A. Personnel** | | | | | |
| A1 | Project manager (0.8 FTE) | 52,000 | 53,560 | 55,167 | 160,727 |
| A2 | Field ecologist (1.0 FTE) | 58,000 | 59,740 | 61,532 | 179,272 |
| A3 | Community outreach officer (0.5 FTE) | 24,000 | 24,720 | 25,462 | 74,182 |
| A4 | Fringe benefits at 28 per cent | 37,520 | 38,646 | 39,805 | 115,971 |
| | **Subtotal personnel** | **171,520** | **176,666** | **181,966** | **530,152** |
| **B. Equipment** | | | | | |
| B1 | Water quality sondes (4) | 18,400 | - | - | 18,400 |
| B2 | Field laptops (3) | 4,500 | - | - | 4,500 |
| B3 | Boat and trailer | 12,800 | - | - | 12,800 |
| B4 | Safety equipment | 1,900 | 600 | 600 | 3,100 |
| | **Subtotal equipment** | **37,600** | **600** | **600** | **38,800** |
| **C. Travel** | | | | | |
| C1 | Local mileage | 2,400 | 2,400 | 2,400 | 7,200 |
| C2 | Conference attendance | 3,200 | - | 3,200 | 6,400 |
| | **Subtotal travel** | **5,600** | **2,400** | **5,600** | **13,600** |
| **D. Contractors** | | | | | |
| D1 | Native plant nursery | 21,000 | 21,000 | 14,000 | 56,000 |
| D2 | Bank engineering works | 34,000 | 28,000 | - | 62,000 |
| D3 | Independent evaluation | - | - | 16,500 | 16,500 |

| Line | Description | Year 1 | Year 2 | Year 3 | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | **Subtotal contractors** | **55,000** | **49,000** | **30,500** | **134,500** |
| **E. Other direct costs** | | | | | |
| E1 | Printing and signage | 3,100 | 1,800 | 1,200 | 6,100 |
| E2 | Volunteer insurance | 1,400 | 1,400 | 1,400 | 4,200 |
| E3 | Workshop venues | 2,600 | 2,600 | 2,600 | 7,800 |
| | **Subtotal other direct costs** | **7,100** | **5,800** | **5,200** | **18,100** |
| | **Total direct costs** | **276,820** | **234,466** | **223,866** | **735,152** |
| | Indirect costs at 12 per cent of direct costs | 33,218 | 28,136 | 26,864 | 88,218 |
| | **TOTAL REQUEST** | **310,038** | **262,602** | **250,730** | **823,370** |

## Justification

1) The project manager coordinates landowners, contractors and the volunteer programme across all three years.
2) The field ecologist carries out the monthly water quality survey and the annual plant and bird counts.
3) Four sondes are needed so that two survey teams can work at the same time on different reaches.
4) The independent evaluation in year 3 is carried out by a university team chosen by open tender.

## Match funding

| Source | Status | Amount |
|---|---|---|
| Eastfield District Council | Confirmed | $30,000 |
| Millrace Angling Society | Confirmed | $8,500 |
| Local water company | Pending decision in March | $45,000 |
| Volunteer time (1,200 hours at $18) | Estimated | $21,600 |
| **Total match funding** | | **$105,100** |

## Risks we have planned for

- Flood events delaying bank works: the contractor schedule leaves a four-week reserve each autumn.
- Loss of volunteers: a paid outreach officer keeps the volunteer register and runs monthly events.
- Invasive species returning: a three-year monitoring plan is built into the ecologist's duties.

## Milestones

| Milestone | Deliverable |
|---|---|
| Month 3 | Landowner agreements signed for all 14 km |
| Month 9 | First 4 km of bank re-profiled and planted |
| Month 18 | Mid-term review and published monitoring report |
| Month 30 | Final planting complete, 14 km restored |
| Month 36 | Independent evaluation delivered to the funder |

All figures are in United States dollars and exclude sales tax. The trust confirms that no part of this request is funded from another public source.